

Regular Meeting
Monday, December 16, 2019
Medford School Committee
Medford City Hall

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, Student Representative Isabella DeSouza.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:07pm.

Approval of the Minutes of December 9, 2019 - Mr. Ruseau - Rules report of committee - handbooks should be printed every year but not reprinted midyear - Motion to approve as amended offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report of Committees - Special Education Subcommittee - 12.9.19 - Ms. DiBenedetto - We had many administrators present for our first meeting of this school year. We had set forth two goals last year. We put in a lot of work, especially Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell. The goals from the prior year will continue. We discussed goals for next year but did not set goals, saving that decision for the person who will chair the subcommittee next year. Setting small goals is important because you can see effective change. It has been a great honor to be the chairperson of this committee. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you for your work on that committee. Limiting the goals was an excellent plan and we will make sure the work continues and stays focused. Ms. Caldwell - We would like to present flowers to Ms. DiBenedetto on behalf of the Special Education department. Motion to accept the report offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Motion to suspend the order of business to take item 2 out of order offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Recognition of Medford State Delegation for Contributions to Student Opportunity Act - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent - I would like to ask Senator Patricia Jehlen, Representative Christine

Barber, Representative Paul Donato, and Representative Sean Garballey to step forward and we would like to thank you for the work you have done to move forward the Student Opportunity Act. We present to you this school bell and this certificate of gratitude. Senator Jehlen - This took a lot of years. We have been trying to do this for 17 years and since the report that came out in 2015. It happened because parents and students and teachers and administrators and school committee members came together and did not give us a lot of choice. I thank Mayor Burke and the staff in Medford for briefing us on how this will help Medford and send the thanks back to you. Representative Barber - I thank you all, the school committee, Mayor Burke, you all are not shy about letting us know about Medford's needs, this will especially help Medford and special education students. Representative Sean Garballey - I thank everyone here tonight, I thank my colleagues, it is a \$1.5 billion investment in cities and towns, and thank you to the Mayor and school committee members for sending messages and advocating for Medford's students. Mayor Burke - I would also like to acknowledge the work of our state delegation and those beyond. They also had special monies put aside for this year and we are so thankful for all you have done for the city of Medford. Ms. Van der Kloot - We thank the state delegation for you always having been there for us. We will need your continued work to ensure appropriations.

Report on Veteran's Day - Dr. Nicole Chiesa - In honor of Veteran's Day, the Humanities Department and the Office of Veterans Services put on a speaker program and was an opportunity for students and faculty to interact with veterans directly. Ms. Kreatz - It was a great program and a wonderful opportunity for students to hear real stories from veterans. Thank you to everybody involved. Dr. Chiesa - A huge thank you to the veterans as well, many work for the city and are graduates of Medford High School. Ms. Van der Kloot - Can we send letters of thanks to Noah Kreatz and to the veterans who participated? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I attended the event in a classroom where there were some English Learners and the teacher was able to use the lesson as an opportunity to point out some vocabulary, it was a good lesson. Motion to place report on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Report on Pilot Provision 2 Breakfast Program - Kirsteen Patterson - We did a very aggressive campaign to encourage participation in free breakfast at the schools. Flyers were sent to schools, posters were made and advertising was done on a billboard. The analysis shows an increase in participation with one exception of the Columbus Elementary school. The Columbus has "breakfast after the bell" but the decline in participation reflects an option for 5th grade students to eat prior to the bell and go directly to classes. Food service is still in negotiation for wages and will impact wages going forward. It is our recommendation to continue to go forward with free breakfast. Ms. DiBenedetto - I want to stop and appreciate all the work that you have done, the increase in high school students eating breakfast is phenomenal. It is because of the work of many in our district and it is greatly appreciated. I hope we will keep pushing for breakfast after the bell across the district, but keep it up, this was a great success. Mr. Ruseau - Thank you for

this hard work. I know it was a lot of work for you and food service. I would not have expected to see such an increase at the Andrews Middle School. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Mayor Burke read condolences for Sgt. Cesar de la Torre and Lena DiGiantommaso.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Tonight is a special night that is both happy and sad. It is the end of the year and the beginning of our holiday season. We wish you a happy holiday whatever you celebrate. On the other hand we will say goodbye to three members of our school committee: Mayor Stephanie Muccini Burke, Erin DiBenedetto, and Michael Ruggiero who have all proudly served the Medford Public Schools. Ms. Van der Kloot - It is bittersweet to say goodbye to our colleagues. Michael, I stood out with you all day on election day and found you to be an enriching presence on the school committee. I suspect we will hear more from you in the future. Specifically, as you talked about reelection you spoke about the obesity epidemic and as a continuing school committee member, I can tell you I will take up that mantle. Erin, I can not believe that you have been on the school committee for 8 years and that you are leaving. I remember all your work for the prom dress project and your work for the Curtis Tufts High School and for the Special Education Subcommittee. Your tenacity and thoughtfulness let me know that you will continue to be an active member of the Medford community. Thank you for your dedication, your time, and your commitment to the children of Medford. Ms. Kreatz - Thank you Michael and Erin for your friendship and your leadership. I wish you both success and happiness in your future ventures. Mayor Burke, I have seen your passion and dedication to the city of Medford shine through. I wish you the best and greatest success in your future. Ms. Van der Kloot - Mayor Burke, you have been a fantastic mayor for the city of Medford. You have been a fantastic chair of the school committee. Your accomplishments have been great. It was wonderful to see that piece of you, with the students, in the halls of schools. We made a transition from a longstanding superintendent to doing an inclusive search and bringing in Dr. Edouard-Vincent and that should be high on your list of accomplishments. It is hard to say goodbye, but we hope you will play a very active role in Medford in the future. How do we move on and through and make the best for our students? Thank you for your leadership and your friendship. Mayor Burke - It has been four great years. It has been an honor and a privilege to get to know all the people in the school department.

Ms. DiBenedetto - I want to say thank you to my family for giving up time with me for me to be able to serve my community in this way.

Mr. Ruggiero - Thank you for the great honor to serve Medford. Thank you to my kids and my wife, it has been a great honor Mayor Burke, Madam Superintendent.

Senator Jehlen - I have a resolution from the Senate noting the Mayor's accomplishments including appointing a new Chief of Police and Superintendent. I also have a citation for Erin DiBenedetto noting her work in the Special Education Subcommittee and a citation for Michael Ruggiero and I also would like to note that we do not expect any of you to go away any time soon.

Representative Barber - I want say to Mayor Burke that when I was at the Medford Conversations table full of high school students that they told me one of the places they felt most comfortable in the city was in their school and that is a testament to the work of the school committee.

Representative Garballey - The work of the school committee is important work that improves the lives of students. You prioritize all students but also the most vulnerable students, thank you for your work upon your retirement. When Mayor Burke was sworn in four years ago, she called me and said she wanted to work with the state delegation to transform Medford. The kind of professionalism she brought to running city government brought many successes. You led the city with such success and so much grace that I think even though it was only four years it felt like a lot longer and the benefit you have brought to Medford and to the students of Medford will be felt for decades.

Representative Donato - We as a delegation have always dedicated ourselves to education. The free breakfast is another milestone we have. I can tell you that the speaker of the house has set education as a priority. On a personal note, I met Michael many years ago and we became friends. We both have a passion for food. Michael has dedicated himself to the city of Medford and we wish him well. Erin and I have a personal relationship, Erin was the caretaker to my cousin who lived down the street from her. Erin, you have dedicated yourself to education and special needs and I know you will continue to work for the people of Medford, that is your vocation. Madam Mayor, in 1996 we both won our first election and worked together as city councillors. She is a dedicated public servant whose first thought is for the people of Medford. She worked day and night to ensure the city's finances were in the best shape they could possibly be. Her legacy will be a new police station, a new library, a new police chief, and a new Superintendent. Madam Mayor, you made a mark on this community, you can be proud of what you have done, you have made Medford great.

Mr. Ruseau - Thank you for your leadership as our mayor and chair of the school committee. You have shown incredible poise and I have learned a lot from you. I thank you for your years of service.

Ms. Mustone - We are still working toward our original goals, but it is with your help that we are making progress toward our goals. You always thought of the children and families first. Mayor Burke - We are always able to put things aside in order to move forward and keep focused on the kids.

Motion to enter executive session offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto.
Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

8:08pm.

Motion to exit executive session offered by Mr. Ruseau at 8:15pm, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Motion to adjourn, motion passes at 8:15pm.